AIPAF

AFRICAN INSTITUTE OF PROJECT ASSURANCE AND FORENSICS

We certify the people who deliver projects, and the projects themselves.

A professional body and a certification body for project assurance and forensics, built for African delivery conditions and governed on the continent.

FOR PRACTITIONERS

FOR SPONSORS, LENDERS AND OWNERS

WHY THE INSTITUTE EXISTS

A sponsor is told how a project is going by the people delivering it.

Where the news is bad, the incentive to soften it sits with the party best placed to know. That is the circuit independent certification exists to break.

Africa does not lack projects. It lacks, in too many cases, the three things that turn a project into a reliable asset: independent scrutiny before money is committed, a record sound enough to survive examination afterwards, and practitioners held to a standard somebody enforces.

The consequences are visible. Infrastructure stalls and is abandoned. Disputes run for years on evidence nobody can test. Capital prices African project risk accordingly, and the cost of that pricing is borne by the public.

Three recurring failures

- **Weak front-end assurance.** Decisions to sanction and finance taken without independent challenge.
- **Thin diagnostic capability.** When a project stalls, no independent account of what happened and why.
- **No professional standard.** The practitioners who do this work answer to no body that examines or disciplines them.

WHAT FOLLOWS FROM THAT

The Institute was founded to supply what is missing, and it does so in two ways rather than one. It examines and certifies practitioners, which is what a professional body does. It also certifies projects and assets against published schemes, which is what a certification body does. Both end in a public register anyone can search.

THE MANDATE

Two certification streams, carrying equal weight.

Most professional bodies certify people. AIPAF certifies the project as well, because a client needs an answer about the project, not only about the person advising on it.

PEOPLE

Certification of practitioners

Examined credentials, a binding code of conduct, and a credential that can be withdrawn.

- Three credential tracks: deliver, assure, investigate
- Grades from Graduate to Fellow
- Continuing professional development, audited
- Discipline, with findings published

Who it is for
Project managers, quantity surveyors, engineers, auditors, cost and claims consultants, and expert witnesses.

PROJECTS & ASSETS

Certification of the project itself

An independent verdict against a published scheme, assessed by people with no interest in the answer.

- Four schemes, by what is being certified
- Granted or refused, never ranked or scored
- Surveillance, suspension and withdrawal
- Every certificate on a public register

Who it is for
Sponsors, boards, lenders, ministries, funds, purchasers and receivers.

THE CONNECTION BETWEEN THEM

The same standards govern both, so a certificate and an expert report rest on the same published basis. Every forensic investigation also produces evidence about why projects fail, and that evidence is the raw material of better assurance.

And one rule holding them apart

The Institute sells no advisory or forensic work within the scope of its schemes. A body that certified a project and also sold the review of it would be examining its own work. Page 8 explains what happens instead.

STREAM ONE

Certifying practitioners

Three credential tracks across the project lifecycle, resting on one common foundation, so that every certified member can read the others' work.

Credential	Function	Core question it answers
CPMP Certified Project Management Practitioner	Deliver	Can this project be delivered soundly to time, cost, and intended benefit?
CPAP Certified Project Assurance Practitioner	Assure	Can this project deliver what it promised, and what must change if not?
CPFE Certified Project Forensic Examiner	Investigate	What went wrong, why, who is responsible, and what is the loss?

GRADES

Fellow (FAIPAF), Member (MAIPAF) and Associate (AAIPAF) carry the right to practise under the Institute's designations. Affiliate and Graduate classes carry no post-nominal. Honorary Fellowship is conferred by the Council.

ENTRY ROUTES

Three roads to the same standard: the professional route for established practitioners from cognate fields, the graduate route, and an experience route assessed on a portfolio of work. No route is faster because of where a candidate studied.

The firewall

A member may not provide independent assurance or forensic services on a project they delivered. The Institute certifies competence in all three domains and keeps delivery and independent scrutiny strictly apart in practice.

A second firewall binds the Institute itself, and the two should be read together. See page 8.

STREAM TWO

Certifying projects and assets

Four schemes, because the unit being certified differs and a single scheme would have to be vague enough to cover all of them.

Scheme	What is certified	Commissioned by
Project Assurance	A project in delivery: baseline integrity, records, change control, forecasting, risk	Sponsors, boards, lenders
Asset Certification	A completed asset: the as-built position and the basis of the final account	Purchasers, lenders, public owners
Revival Assurance	A stalled or abandoned project: recoverability, residual scope, conditions for restart	Ministries, lenders, receivers
Portfolio & Programme	A sponsor's assurance regime across many projects	Funds, agencies, sponsors

WHAT A CERTIFICATE SAYS

That the project conformed with the named scheme, in a defined scope, as at a stated date. All four facts appear on the certificate and on the register.

WHAT IT DOES NOT SAY

It is not a warranty, guarantees no outcome, does not warrant design adequacy or regulatory compliance, and transfers no risk to the Institute. It may be withdrawn.

Granted or refused, never graded

There are no levels or scores. Grading would require a defensible standard at each level and an answer to why a project sits at one rather than the next, which invites challenge to the Institute rather than to the project.

FEATURE SCHEME

Revival Assurance: the certificate nobody else issues.

Uncompleted public infrastructure is among the largest unaddressed problems in African project delivery. Capital sits locked in structures nobody will restart, because nobody will give an independent view on whether restarting is feasible.

WHAT IS ASSESSED

- Physical condition, deterioration, and what remains usable
- Completeness of surviving records, and what must be reconstructed
- Residual scope to reach a defined, usable state
- Contractual and legal position still unresolved
- Conditions precedent to restart, as a list a sponsor can work through

WHAT IT DELIBERATELY DOES NOT SAY

Whether restarting is a sound investment, which is a commercial judgment for the sponsor. And who caused the project to stall, which is contested, party-specific, and the subject of a separate forensic instruction.

Holding that boundary is what allows the certificate to be relied on by every party at once. A certificate that apportioned blame would be contested by whoever it named.

> A lender, a ministry, a receiver, or an incoming contractor needs one independent answer: is this worth finishing, and on what terms. No body on the continent currently issues it.

THE PROOF

Two public registers. One lookup.

Certification that cannot be checked is an assertion. Everything we certify, and everything we have stopped certifying, is on a register anyone may search without an account and without charge.

Register of Professionals

Members by grade and designation, competences held, status, and any published disciplinary finding.

AIPAF-P-0000

Register of Projects and Assets

Certified projects, assets, revivals and portfolios, with the scheme, the scope, the dates, and the status.

AIPAF-A-0000

WHAT THE REGISTER SHOWS THAT OTHERS HIDE

- Lapsed, resigned, suspended and expelled members
- Suspended, withdrawn and expired certificates
- Published disciplinary findings

Publishing a suspension can embarrass a holder, and the objection is understood. A register showing only live certificates could tell a client nothing in the one case where they most need to know. What is published, and for how long, is fixed in the scheme rather than decided case by case, and every withdrawal may be appealed.

For procurement officers

Model clauses for requiring a certified practitioner or a certified project in a tender are published, along with a data feed for organisations that verify at volume.

IMPARTIALITY

We decline the work our members do.

AIPAF performs no forensic audit, no delay and quantum analysis, no cost or value review for clients. It would be profitable, our members are the people who do it, and we decline it on purpose.

THE REASON

A certification body may not provide consultancy on the subject matter it certifies. A body that certified a project and also sold the forensic review of that project would be examining its own work, and its certificate would be worth nothing to the lender or tribunal that needed an independent view.

It is also the rule accreditation is assessed against, so a body that breaches it cannot be accredited.

WHAT HAPPENS INSTEAD

The Institute assesses who is competent to do forensic work and lists them on the **Expert Panel**, by individual competence. Clients instruct a panel member directly, on their own terms. The Institute is not a party to the engagement and takes no fee from it.

The arrangement serves members as well as clients. It makes the register the route to paid work, which is what gives a credential commercial value rather than ornamental value.

PANEL COMPETENCES

- Forensic delay analysis
- Quantum and loss
- Project cost engineering
- Value management
- Project audit and assurance
- Stalled and abandoned project investigation

Two firewalls, read together

A member may not assure or investigate a project they delivered. The Institute may not take instructions on anything it certifies. A reader who sees only the first will assume the Institute is free to act where the member is not.

HOW WE ARE HELD TO ACCOUNT

A body that certifies others must be governed to the standard it demands.

The safeguards below are written to the requirements that certification bodies are accredited against, because a body is assessed on what it has actually been doing.

SAFEGUARDS

- **Separation of powers.** Those who set standards, certify against them, and discipline are different bodies.
- **Conflicts declared.** Anyone with an interest withdraws from the decision.
- **No consultancy** on anything within the scope of our schemes.
- **Training kept apart from examining.** Our courses are never a condition of certification and confer no advantage.
- **A right of appeal** against every decision, to a panel that did not take it.
- **Transparency.** The registers, the code, the standards and disciplinary outcomes are public.

Accreditation

The Institute intends both activities to be accredited: certification of persons under **ISO/IEC 17024**, and certification of projects and assets under **ISO/IEC 17065**.

Accreditation is what allows a certificate issued in Accra to be relied on elsewhere. Until it is granted we state our stage plainly and use no accreditation mark.

Current stage: [STAGE], [DATE]

Registered under NRCD 143

The Institute is registered as a professional body under the Professional Bodies Registration Act, 1973, administered by the Office of the Registrar of Companies, Accra.

THE EVIDENCE BASE

Standards both streams are judged against.

A forensic report prepared to a published methodology can be tested against that methodology. One prepared to the author's own preference can only be tested against another author's preference.

THE STANDARDS

- Forensic delay analysis
- Quantum and loss
- Project audit and assurance
- Project cost engineering
- Value management
- Revival of stalled and abandoned projects

Each is drafted by a panel, issued for public consultation, reviewed by the International Advisory Council, and adopted with its version and date recorded. Comments received are published with the response to each.

Abandoned Projects Observatory

Nobody knows with any rigour how much public capital sits in projects that were started and never finished. The Observatory assembles it: a published methodology, country studies prepared with local institutions, and an annual index of value locked up in uncompleted public assets.

It reports in aggregate and anonymised form, and does not name individual projects, sponsors, contractors or officials.

CONVENING

The Institute convenes the profession through technical meetings, the ICESDA conference series, and a research and publications programme directed at the causes of project failure.

HOW TO JOIN

Two applications, because we certify two things.

FOR PRACTITIONERS

Apply for membership

Membership is assessed on evidence of practice, teaching or examining. The Committee admits to grade and states its reasons.

YOU WILL NEED

- Form AIPAF/M1, completed and signed
- Certified copies of qualifications
- A record of actual engagements, not a description of your role
- A proposer and seconder, for the professional grades

Apply at [EMAIL]

FOR SPONSORS AND OWNERS

Apply to certify a project

Choose the scheme, define the scope, and declare the records available. Declared gaps are assessable; undeclared gaps stop an assessment.

WHAT YOU ARE AGREEING TO

- Assessment against the published scheme, which may end in refusal
- Publication of the outcome on the register, including suspension
- Notification of any material change
- A certificate that transfers no risk to the Institute

Apply at [EMAIL]

Founding cohort

The Institute is admitting its founding cohort and certifying its first projects. Those who join at this stage help to set the standard rather than inherit it, and are recorded as founding members.

Assure the promise.
Establish the truth.

MEMBERSHIP
[EMAIL]

CERTIFICATION
[EMAIL]

REGISTERS
[WEBSITE]

Registered as a professional body under the Professional Bodies Registration Act, 1973 (NRCD 143). Administered jointly with Green Communities International and the African Corporate Governance Network.

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